Six math clues · answer key

Cornstarch Goo

Add or subtract the ones first; trade a ten when the ones need it.

Math 1 · 73

46 + 27 = 73. 6 + 7 makes 13, so trade 10 ones for a ten.

Math 2 · 34

52 − 18 = 34. Trade a ten for ones, then take away the smacked spoon.

Math 3 · 83

38 + 45 = 83. 8 + 5 makes 13, so trade 10 ones for a ten.

Math 4 · 35

63 − 28 = 35. Trade a ten for ones, then take away the melted cracks.

Math 5 · 43

19 + 24 = 43. 9 + 4 makes 13, so trade 10 ones for a ten.

Math 6 · 36

72 − 36 = 36. Trade a ten for ones, then take away the washed-away prints.

Three additions and three subtractions, each with regrouping. The numbers are for practice, not real goo measurements.

Reading & writing · answer key

Cornstarch Goo

Reading · 1

It feels hard, like a table.

Reading · 2

Water flows the same fast or slow; the goo turns hard.

Reading · 3

The water cannot move in time, so the grains lock.

Reading · 4

Jammed grains poke up through the water.

Reading · 5

One crowd of grains; the push decides.

Reading · 6

Grains spread apart, and water sinks into the gaps.

Math · all

73, 34, 83, 35, 43, 36.

Screen-free

Hard for a moment; tiny grains in water; grains poke up; it goes pale.

Cornstarch goo is for touching, not tasting. Cover the table and wipe spills while wet. Never pour goo down a sink, because it can clog the drain; let it dry and put it in the trash.

Offer dictation: let the child say a complete thought while you write it, then invite a picture or label.

Four looks at goo

Cornstarch Goo

Quiz 1. What happens if you tap the goo fast?

A fast tap jams the grains, so the goo feels hard for a moment.

Quiz 2. What is cornstarch goo made of?

It is tiny cornstarch grains with thin water between them.

Quiz 3. Why does squeezed goo look dry?

Jammed grains need more room, so they poke up through the water.

Quiz 4. What does wet sand do when you step on it?

The grains spread apart and water sinks in, so the top looks dry.

Cornstarch goo is for touching, not tasting. Cover the table and wipe spills while wet. Never pour goo down a sink, because it can clog the drain; let it dry and put it in the trash.